TASK 3: SUBSTRATE IDENTIFICATION AND REPAIR METHOD SELECTION

Vehicle Damage Paint Technician Level 3 | Block 2 | v1.1

TIME	EVIDENCE	PROGRAMME POINT
60 minutes	**Practical | Knowledge | Documentation**	**Weeks 11-28**

Your task

A damaged vehicle has several panel areas made from different materials. You must identify the substrate, confirm the suitable repair/refinish route and record the controls required before preparation continues.

What you must do

1. Confirm the panel area and inspect it without causing further damage.
2. Identify the substrate using safe visual and approved checking methods.
3. Consult product or OEM information to select the correct repair approach.
4. Record any restrictions such as aluminium control, plastic adhesion or composite referral.
5. Explain your chosen method and evidence to the assessor.

What good evidence looks like

SAFE SETUP

Suitable PPE, a prepared work area and controlled vehicle, component or equipment.

CORRECT METHOD

A logical sequence using the relevant procedure and technical information.

ACCURATE EVIDENCE

Actual readings, findings and actions recorded clearly and precisely.

SOUND DECISIONS

Appropriate recommendations, referral or authorisation supported by evidence.

You will need

- Vehicle panels or substrate sample set
- OEM or product technical information
- Identification charts, magnets, inspection lamp and PPE
- Repair method selection worksheet
- Apprentice Assessment Record

SOW ALIGNMENT

Block 2 - Core Paint Preparation, Materials and Workflow
Duties: D1-D5, D10 KSB evidence focus: K1, K4, K6, K7, S1-S4, B1, B6
Task reference: Block_2_Task_3_Substrate_Identification_and_Repair_Method_Selection

TASK 3: SUBSTRATE IDENTIFICATION AND REPAIR METHOD SELECTION

Practical record

Apprentice, location and vehicle details

Apprentice name

Date

TASK COMPLETED AT ○ APPRENTICE'S WORKPLACE ○ TRAINING CENTRE

Vehicle make

Model

Registration

Mileage

Panel / repair area

VIN / chassis number

Measurements and technical checks

Substrate identified		Identification method	
OEM data checked		Product data checked	
Process selected		Special control required	
Referral required		Evidence reference	

Technical data, identification checks, product information or method reference

Task evidence

PPE and precautions used

Safety-critical findings and immediate action

Work completed, findings and recommendations

Knowledge check

1. Why must the substrate be identified before selecting refinish materials?

2. What could happen if aluminium is prepared using contaminated equipment?

Knowledge check - continued

3. (a) Why might plastic parts require adhesion promoter or specialist preparation? (b) When should OEM or product data be checked rather than relying on memory?

4. How can carbon fibre or GRP change the repair/refinish route?

5. (a) What information should be recorded to justify your selected method? (b) Which findings would make you stop and refer the job?

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation

- ☐ Identify common vehicle substrates including steel, aluminium, plastics and composites.
- ☐ Use technical information to select a suitable preparation/refinish route.
- ☐ Recognise when specialist advice or manufacturer information is required.
- ☐ Record substrate evidence, risks and method decisions clearly.
- ☐ Explain how substrate choice affects product and process selection.

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation notes

Decision and feedback

Decision - select one

◯ **PASS** ◯ **REFER**

Evidence reference

Feedback and action required

Sign-off

Signatures confirm that this is the apprentice's own work and that the evidence and decision are accurate.

Apprentice name

Assessor/Workplace Mentor name

Apprentice signature

Assessor/Workplace Mentor signature

PIN (if applicable)

Date

Vehicle Damage Paint L3

Task answer continuation | Form accessibility revision 12 November 2026

Use this page when an answer will not fit visibly in its original box.
Reference the question and write "See continuation page" in the original answer.
Keep each response within the visible space. Add another copy of this page if needed.

Apprentice name

Block / task / page number

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Continuation evidence must be reviewed with the original task and referenced at sign-off.